

1571 OTTOMAN DEFEAT AT SEA

The fleet of a coalition of Christian states including Spain, Venice, and Genoa inflicted a heavy defeat on the navy of the

Ottoman Empire at the Battle of Lepanto. Fought off the coast of Greece, it was the last European sea battle contested by oared warships. Around 400 galleys and 150,000 men took part.

▷ *The Battle of Lepanto*,
Andreas van Eertvelt, 1640



◁ Light from the galley of the Marqués de Santa Cruz at Lepanto



1560

1566 The Dutch Revolt
against Philip II of Spain
breaks out in the
Low Countries

1572 The Wanli Emperor
takes charge in Ming China;
his reign lasts 48 years

**1562 The French Wars
of Religion** break out
between Catholics and
Protestant Huguenots

1569 The Union of Lublin
formally unites Poland and
Lithuania in the Polish-
Lithuanian Commonwealth



1572 HUGUENOT MASSACRE

France's Huguenots (Protestants) gathered in Paris, a mostly Catholic city, to celebrate the wedding of Huguenot Henry of Navarre to French King Charles IX's sister. Probably on the king's orders, leading Huguenots were murdered, and the killing of Protestants by Catholic mobs followed. This massacre on St Bartholomew's Day was the most notorious episode of France's Religious Wars (1562-98).

◁ St Bartholomew's Day massacre

Three million people are estimated to
have died in the French Wars of Religion